

To Thomas A. Edison
— a man who has
made good.

With best wishes
from E. W. Zalsman

Oct 25. 1921

Inscribed to Thomas Edison -
with 14 pages annotated
in Edison's hand.

constructive aids more generally to the larger phases of business activities.

Each and every one of us has been put in this world for some purpose. There is some attainable goal toward which all are travelling. Whether we arrive at that goal or not depends wholly upon ourselves. Men are born with a certain intellect or talent the development of which is unlimited and almost wholly within their own power. The psychologists tell us that we are born with a certain amount of intellect. We perhaps cannot add one iota to this intellect, but that intellect with which we are born is capable of being developed.

Obstacles

The Bible gives us a parable of a man who before travelling into a far country called his servants together. Unto one he gave five talents, to another two, and to another one, each according to his several ability. The one who received five talents developed his talents one hundredfold, but the man who re-

ceived one talent felt that he had accomplished quite a little to preserve that one talent and present it to his lord intact. At the same time he took that opportunity to proclaim that he knew his lord was a hard taskmaster. For this wicked slothfulness his lord rebuked him and taking the talent from him gave it to the servant who had ten. The development of the talents given us or the intellect with which we are born is one of the first steps toward our goal of making good. The road to this goal of making good is beset with many obstacles. These obstacles are mostly imaginary. They are mostly fears. They are almost all subjective ideas. Strange as it may seem an imaginary obstacle has just as much of a deterrent effect upon the individual as if it were a real obstacle. Were it not for this, obstacles would not be here mentioned at all.

The most frequent obstacles, imaginary or real, met with are (1) the erroneous belief that every man who has accomplished great things is a genius; (2) lack

Capacity of having an intellect
99% lost by atrophy

Hard work, consecutive thinking, and the exercise of judgment are the things that help a man make good.

Blaming Economic System

If you visit Boston Common on some nice sunny spring Sunday afternoon you may hear a polyglot of orations blaming our social economic or political order for the failures of the great mass of people. It is rather paradoxical that Joseph Fels, manufacturer of Fels-Naptha soap, once blamed the same social, economic and political order for his marvellous success! The same energy, time, and effort spent in blaming our economic order devoted to making good would achieve the desired result.

Men are successful because they have certain six characteristics referred to in a later chapter. These soap box orators seem to think that men are successful because they have money or because an economic system favours them. The causation is just the other way. Men are not successful because they have wealth.

They have wealth because they are successful. Men are not successful because the economic order favours them, but they are successful because they take advantage of the opportunities existing under the economic order. Sometimes the erroneous concept of the causes of success finds its way into the laws of our land. This is evidenced by the various hindrances that are placed as distinct barriers in the path of business. But even laws cannot prevent men from being successful unless those laws can obliterate the intellect from the mind of man. So far laws have been unable to annul intellect or its results;—and, the result of intellect is success.

Trusting to Luck

Even in this day of developed intellect and enlightened civilization there are those who are trusting "luck" to make good. This, that, or the other man who has made good is "lucky." In every game of chance the odds are against the player. With the odds against the player, if he

*Oh No - 2 play - then one
must be a winner*

latter. While we should not slacken our pace to the least degree, I beseech the employers of this land periodically to look over their plants with a view to finding men in the ranks of their labourers for the specific purpose of giving them an opportunity to develop themselves.

A Lesson in Algebra

The captains of industry to-day came from the ranks of the wage-workers of yesterday. The captains of industry tomorrow must come from the ranks of the wage-workers of to-day. Opportunity to develop is the *sine qua non* of making good. Make your own opportunity if you can. A great many progressive employers are awake to the need of giving you the opportunity. Coöperation in this between employer and wage-worker is an important factor in our development. A much more important factor is your ability to recognize an opportunity when it arrives. Opportunity taps once at every man's door.

Higher Officials
no longer
Come in
Contact
with their
men like
the Pioneer Official

"Opportunity tapped at a door
With a chance for the brother within;
He rapped till his fingers were sore
And muttered: 'Come on, let me in.
Here is something I know you can do,
Here's a hill that I know you can climb.'
But the brother inside
Very quickly replied:
'Old fellow, I haven't got time.'

"Opportunity wandered along
In search of a man who would rise,
He said to the indolent throng:
'Here's a chance for the fellow who tries.'
But each of them said with a smile,
'I wish I could do it, but I'm
Very busy to-day
And I'm sorry to say
That really I haven't got time.'

"At last Opportunity came
To a man who was burdened with cares,
And said: 'I now offer the same
Opportunity that has been theirs.
Here's a duty that ought to be done,
It's a chance if you've got time to take it.'
Said the man, with a grin,
'Come along, pass it in!
I'll either find time or I'll make it.'

is possible for him to become an employer, that it is possible for him to become even a capitalist, and that all these things are possible under our present social, economic, and political order. Not only possible, yea, they are all stimulated by our present system. Hence, labour leaders should not teach labour that it must always remain labour. The possibilities of the individual of development should be inculcated in the minds of the great mass of workers. Each man should know that there is an attainable goal; that he has latent power; that he has talents; that he has intellect; that all of these things are capable of development; and that the possibilities of developing them lie almost wholly within himself.

Inherited Wealth

Inherited wealth should also be tabulated more as a hindrance than as an aid. A man once said: "My father left me a great inheritance." The truthfulness of his statement was apparent when he continued by stating that his father left him

History proves that religion is a curse
and is the master scheme for exploitation
of man

good health and poverty. Making good comes from religion and work. Those factors are developed in humble homes. All hindrances, both imaginary and real, properly considered by each individual may be utilized as aids rather than obstacles. Success comes not from the advantages that we have but from the obstacles which we overcome. If you are really in earnest about making good, answer these questions: Have you confidence in your ability to succeed? Upon what do you base that confidence? Are you conscious of any faults that may interfere with your progress? Can they be overcome? What are you doing to overcome them?

Some one has said that in order to achieve success you must keep your eyes on the stars, your ear to the ground, and your nose on the grindstone. I have never been quite able to figure out the physical contortion necessary to perform this feat. Nevertheless, if taken in separate doses the statement has a meaning.

God helps nobody. 20 million
perished directly & indirectly in
the late War - for no fault of theirs
why did God permit this

III THE SIX "I'S" OF MAKING GOOD

HERE are numerous statements
relating to "The Way to
Wealth"; if there is a new idea
in them, help yourself:

The Way to Wealth

"God helps them who help others.

"Industry pays debts, while despair in-
creaseth them.

"If you would have your business done,
go; if not, send.

"Experience keeps a dear school, but
fools will learn in no other.

"Dost thou love life, then do not squander
time, for that is the stuff life is made of.

"Sloth, like rust, consumes faster than
labour wears, while the used key is always
bright.

"Lost time is never found again; and

what we call time enough always proves
little enough.

"He that hath a trade, hath an estate;
and he that hath a calling, hath an office of
profit and honour.

"Never leave till to-morrow that which
you can do to-day. One to-day is worth
two to-morrows.

"The eye of a master will do more work
than both his hands. Keep thy shop and
thy shop will keep thee.

"Silks and satins, scarlet and velvets, put
out the kitchen fire. Fools make feasts, and
wise men eat them.

"Pride breakfasted with plenty, dined
with poverty, and supped with infamy.
Lying rides upon debt's back.

"Constant dropping wears away stones;
and by diligence and patience the mouse ate
in two the cable; and little strokes fell great
oaks.

"A man may, if he knows not how to save
as he gets, keep his nose all his life to the
grindstone, and die not worth a groat at
last. A fat, well-provisioned kitchen makes
a lean will.

"What maintains one vice would bring
up two children.

Good
 twenty-nine working days. There are also during a year twelve holidays, and the twelve holidays subtracted from the twenty-nine working days leave seventeen working days. We all receive one hour for lunch each day. This is equivalent throughout the year to thirteen days. That is, thirteen lunch hour days subtracted from the seventeen working days leave four working days. Now, one knows that there are four Jewish holidays during the year. Four holidays subtracted from the four working days leave no days! Then, why the devil do you ask why prices are high and business is rotten?"

Eliminating duplications, the fact remains that the great mass of us work only twenty-four per cent. of the time.

2. *Integrity*

Industry of itself, however, never gets anybody anywhere. Most animals work a good deal harder than you and I work. The inhabitants of the world during the last million years have always worked.

They have been compelled to work to keep from starving and freezing. Why is it that after these millions of years of work it is only within the last few centuries that people have got anywhere and become healthier, happier, and more prosperous? The reason is that only recently have men learned that with Industry there must go Integrity. The animals are industrious but they are not honest. They steal, they deceive, they refuse to respect the rights and property of others. They are animals and always will remain animals. Civilization really dates from the time that people began to respect the rights and property of others. Hence, the second "I" of success is Integrity. And let me say right here that the real cause of business depressions is the temporary neglect of Industry and Integrity. While our nation's resources are greater than ever and the world's need for goods is more than ever, factories close down because men forget those common virtues of Industry and Integrity which are the basis of prosperity.

ones must set them a good example. Those who are unsuccessful usually have poor habits; while those who are successful, can, in many instances, thank their good habits for the success.

Importance of Religion

A plant might be in the best soil and would never amount to anything if it had no sunshine. It is the same with our young people. The cannibals have good health but they all lack "something." What is it that the cannibals lack? It is religion. Religion bears the same relation to success that sunshine bears to a plant. If statistics have taught me any one thing, it is the truth of that statement of Towson's; namely: "The biggest thing in business is not machinery, materials, or markets; but rather men. The biggest thing in men is not body, mind, or muscle; but soul. Wages, prices, and conditions can be adjusted; but attitudes, motives and relationships can only be converted." Health, education, and money may get young people diplomas, but only

Religion gives no benefits

religion causes them truly to benefit from that Industry, Integrity, Intelligence, Initiative, Intensity, and Inspiration, which bring true success.

If you are endowed with the six "I's" of success and all of these are bathed in the sunshine of religion there is very little else that I can say to you. Success is yours for the asking!

America's educational system. Too many frills and fads have found places in our schools and colleges. Too much time is required to accomplish results. Too many impractical theories are being taught. There are too many teachers with book knowledge and too few with practical knowledge. Despite all these things the educational process, even in its present state, is one of the most constructive aids to making good. The educational period of a man's life is the most important period of his life. It is the formative period. It is the period in which habits, character, associates, friendships, moral and religious attributes are made, formed, and acquired. The educational period is a foundation builder of our future existence.

Money Value of Religious Education

Not only does our individual success depend upon religion and education, but even the national prosperity of our country depends thereupon. In Spain, Russia, Turkey, and Mexico where there

*Outside of Mexico Religion
is the Curse of the Countries
mentioned*

*The Civilized Zone. Religion has nothing
to do with the state of these countries*

is a lack of Christian education, there is the same story of poverty, revolution, and misery regardless of race, climate, or abundance of natural resources. On the other hand, wherever there is adequate provision for such education there follow industrial efficiency and national wealth. Witness such countries as Denmark, Scotland, Switzerland, England, and the United States.

Statistics have been tabulated showing that productivity per man varies directly with the schooling. The poor farmers of Asia, Russia, and India receive from three to fourteen cents per day and only five per cent. of them are literates. In Russia about forty per cent. of the people read and write. In the United States 92.3 per cent. of the people read and write. From the shoulders down, neither men nor nations are worth more than the product of their labours.

There is a class of individuals who still insist that manual labour is the only kind of productive labour. Statistics show that the contributions of intellect are far

*Both
wrong*

more productive than manual labour. I say this with the highest regard for manual labour,—a most honourable kind of work. At the same time we must not close our eyes to the contributions of intellect. Had it not been for the mechanical inventions, industry would not be developed as it is to-day. We could not clothe our people or feed them under primitive methods of production. If prices have been high during the past few years, think what they would be if production were still in the household stage.

What the Record Shows

Some years ago a study was made of the names listed in "Who's Who." This book contains 30,000 names of those who have made good in certain walks of life. Of the 5,000,000 uneducated people in the United States, only thirty-one were listed in the book. This represents only one individual out of 150,000. Of the 33,000,000 grammar students, 808 are listed in the book, or four out of every

150,000. Of the 2,000,000 high school graduates, 1,245 are listed in the book, or ninety-three out of 150,000; and of the 1,000,000 college graduates, 5,768 are tabulated, or 800 out of 150,000. In other words, the child with no schooling has one chance out of 150,000 of making good in a big way. The child with an elementary education has four times the chance. The child with a high school education has ninety-three times the chance, while the child with a college education has 800 times the chance.

From a statistical standpoint it may be interesting to know that while less than one per cent. of American men are college graduates, this one per cent. of college graduates has furnished fifty-five per cent. of our Presidents, thirty-six per cent. of our Members of Congress, forty-seven per cent. of the Speakers of the House, fifty-four per cent. of the Vice-Presidents, sixty-two per cent. of the Secretaries of State, fifty per cent. of the Secretaries of the Treasury, sixty-seven per cent. of Attorney-Generals and

*How fallacious.
How untrue.
Very wrong conclusions are drawn from these statements*

sixty-nine per cent. of Justices of the Supreme Court. These are cold statistical facts that we must accept as a handicap or an advantage in the race of making good.

Mistakes of Students

In my college days I was considerably surprised at the attitude of the general student toward physical and mental training. Probably the same attitude prevails to a greater or less extent to-day. Put the average student on the athletic field and he will obey the physical coach to the letter because he knows it is absolutely necessary to observe the rules in order to make the team. The athletic coach often regulates the hours of sleep and designates the diet. His dictum is accepted without a murmur on the part of the student. Put the same student in the class-room and his attitude toward the mental instructor is very different. If the instructor assigns a chapter from the history of Rome, the student at once questions the advisability of the lesson.

"I do not care what the Romans did. What I want to know is what people are doing to-day," is a very common statement heard in college halls. Whereas, those of experience and training in educational lines know that what is happening to-day is the result of past years of experience.

By a systematic training course we can develop our spiritual, physical, or mental being so that we can perform feats of strength. This fact is universally known. Systematic concentration and properly guided exercises in mental development make for wonderful results. The attitude of the majority of people toward systematic training is not satisfactory. If we can get the great mass of people to understand that they have abilities and potentialities, we can make rapid strides in our race of making good. Religion consists not of creeds nor churches. Physical health is not made up of muscle or weight. Education is not designed to cram us full of data and tabulated information.

What is Education

I suppose. Generalities unsupported by any facts, oratory etc Punk

houses that permitted me to do a part of their statistical work.

The physical rest, forced upon me by the sickness, gave some time to think. Furthermore, figures constantly before me opened my eyes. Gradually my interest in religion came back. I again became active in church work, and my old religious enthusiasm returned. But this time I was converted by statistics rather than by the appeals of an evangelist. Thus my present condition really dates from 1902 rather than from 1894, although I doubtless owe much to Evangelist Munhall who broke the ground. Yes, I was reconverted by statistics, and no man who earnestly studies the figures which come to Wellesley Hills could fail to be converted likewise. Let me give a few illustrations.

Missionary vs. Explorer

Like other young men I had been taught the economics of materialism; namely, that everything comes from "land and labour." The study of statis-

Confucius preached the Golden rule

tics, however, indicated this to be untrue. Statistics showed that there was just as much land and natural resources in this country a thousand years ago as there is to-day, but it was undeveloped. It waited for Christianity and the teachings of integrity, faith, and service before men were willing to do more than was necessary to fill their daily needs. China has greater natural resources than the United States and, moreover, has far greater available labour; and yet, where is China to-day? China has the "land and labour," *but it lacks the religion which supplies the inspiration to develop and make the most of the land and labour.* Statistics show that the orthodox teaching of economics is wrong and cannot stand the test of history. Modern civilization has been built upon three fundamentals; namely, land, labour, and Christianity. What the spark is to the air and gas in the cylinder of an engine, that is Christianity to the land and labour about which we hear so much.

Some lecturers on political economy,